



Po box 642, Avarua, Rarotonga – Cook Islands
Phone: +682 28884 - Mobile: +682 55547

Cook Islands Aquatic Federation (CIAF)

Officials Selection Process – 2024

Eligibility

To be considered for selection, officials must:

- Be eligible to represent the Cook Islands Aquatic Federation (CIAF) as deemed by World Aquatics and CIAF.
- Be in good standing with CIAF and CISNOC.
- Be willing and able to carry out the duties of the role assigned (Coach, Team Manager, Technical Official, or Development Official).

Note: International qualification systems exist (e.g. World Aquatics Bronze/Silver/Gold; USA N-levels; Australian/NZ pathways). CIAF acknowledges these as future standards. At present, the Cook Islands has no fully accredited officials; therefore, selection will focus on competence, reliability, commitment, and potential for development.

Selection Criteria

Officials will be appointed by the **CIAF Officials Appointments Panel** (consisting of the Development Officer, two CIAF Executive members, and one independent advisor).

In making selections, the Panel will consider:

1. **Experience** – history of involvement in swimming, sport management, or related officiating roles.
 2. **Contribution** – service to CIAF programmes, or community events.
 3. **Capability** – ability to manage the duties of the role, including leadership, teamwork, and communication.
 4. **Multi-Role Capacity** – preference for officials who can contribute across more than one area.
 5. **Representation** – balance of gender and regional participation where practical.
 6. **Commitment** – availability for the full duration of team activities, competitions, and media/engagements.
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Competition Requirements

- **World Aquatics / Olympic Competitions**
CIAF will nominate officials in line with World Aquatics, IOC, or CISNOC requirements. Priority will be given to the most experienced and suitable applicants.
 - **Oceania and Regional Competitions**
CIAF will determine the number of officials required and publish the specific roles and criteria at least two months prior to entries closing.
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Development Slots

Each delegation may include **at least one Development Official** whose role will be mentored. This ensures a pathway for emerging officials to gain experience and, over time, international accreditation.

Team Commitments

Officials must be available for all team commitments, which may include:

- Camps, training sessions, and team meetings.
 - On-deck competition duties.
 - Media and community engagements.
- Failure to meet commitments may result in removal from the team.
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Conflicts, Conduct & Removal

Officials must comply with CIAF and World Aquatics Codes of Conduct.

- Conflicts of interest must be declared and managed.
- Breaches of conduct or failure to carry out duties may result in removal and replacement.

Competition Costs

While some competitions are covered by World Aquatics, there may be **user-pays components**, or some competitions may be fully user-pays.

Addendum – Officials Development Pathway for CIAF

CIAF recognises the need to build a pipeline of accredited officials. To this end:

1. **Local Events as Training Grounds**
 - Cook Islands Games and Cook Islands Schools Swimming Sports will be designated as official “training and assessment events.”
 - Prospective officials will be given roles under supervision to gain experience.
2. **Accreditation Pathway**
 - CIAF will work with Oceania Aquatics, Swimming NZ, and Swimming Australia to access introductory training modules (online and in-person).
 - Identified officials will be encouraged to enter the World Aquatics Bronze/Silver/Gold pathway as soon as practical.
3. **Mentorship**
 - Visiting qualified officials (from NZ/Australia/Oceania) will be invited to mentor Cook Islands officials at local events.
4. **Progress Review**
 - CIAF will review officials’ development annually, with a target of having the first internationally accredited Cook Islands officials within the next four-year cycle.